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Deon Grover

London grover.deon@outlook.com +44 7889 291964
www.linkedin.com/in/deon-grover-447273291 https://github.com/DeGro19

Professional Summary

Cybersecurity graduate (1st Class Honours) from Keele University specialising in vulnerability detection, offensive security tooling, and cloud application security. Award-winning researcher with a proven ability to bridge academic theory and real-world vulnerability scanning. Holds Microsoft AZ-204 (Azure Developer Associate), with hands-on experience across the full Azure development stack, including identity and access management, secrets handling with Key Vault, event-driven architecture, container deployments, and application monitoring. Seeking a Junior Security Analyst role to apply research-led, cloud-aware methodologies to enterprise threat detection and secure application development.

Education

Keele University *Sept 2022 - July 2025*

BSc Computer Science (Cyber Security)

- Grade: 1st Class Honours
- Dissertation: "Enhancing SQL Injection Detection in OWASP ZAP using Custom Payload Fuzzing"
- Engineered a custom SQLi detection pipeline in OWASP ZAP using custom payload fuzzing
- Conducted structured vulnerability assessments using WebGoat environments
- Awarded Best Poster at Keele Town Hall; nominated Student of the Year 2025
- Dissertation co-publishing with Dr. Amro Al-Said Ahmad

Projects

Dissertation: SQLi Detection Enhancement in OWASP ZAP - *github.com/DeGro19*

- Developed a custom payload fuzzing library to extend SQLi detection capabilities in OWASP ZAP
- Leveraged Python automation to outperform default scan configurations, delivering a +9% improvement in detection rate validated against the WebGoat environment
- Conducted comparative analysis exposing structural flaws in default OWASP ZAP payloads versus custom payloads
- Awarded Best Poster at Keele Town Hall; nominated Student of the Year 2025; currently co-publishing with Dr. Amro Al-Said Ahmad

Microsoft Azure Cloud Application - *"AZ-204 Developer Associate"*

- Deployed and managed a scalable web application on Azure App Service, configuring SSL, API settings, diagnostics logging, and autoscaling rules for production-grade reliability
- Implemented identity and access controls using the Microsoft Identity Platform and Azure Active Directory, including OAuth 2.0 flows, shared access signatures, and role-based access control.
- Secured application secrets and credentials using Azure Key Vault, implementing best-practice secrets management with key rotation and certificate handling — directly applicable to enterprise security posture
- Designed event-driven messaging pipelines using Azure Service Bus, Event Hub, and Event Grid to handle asynchronous workflows, real-time data ingestion, and decoupled microservice communication
- Configured observability and alerting via Azure Application Insights and Azure Monitor, tracking Failed Requests, Web Activity, and performance anomalies to support proactive incident response
- Managed cloud storage solutions including Azure Cosmos DB (with partitioning schemes and consistency levels), Azure Blob Storage (data archiving and retention policies), and Azure Queue Storage

- Deployed containerised workloads using Azure Container Registry and Azure Container Instances; provisioned and validated infrastructure using ARM templates for repeatable, secure deployments
- Implemented Azure API Management to secure and govern API access, configuring authentication policies and rate-limiting to enforce a defence-in-depth strategy
- Integrated Azure Redis Cache with encryption and expiration policies to optimise application performance whilst maintaining data security.

Certifications

Microsoft:

- AZ-204: Microsoft Certified Azure Developer Associate - App Service, Azure Functions, Key Vault, Azure AD, Service Bus, Event Hub, Event Grid, Cosmos DB, Blob Storage, Container Registry, APIM, Application Insights, Azure Monitor

IBM:

- IBM Cyber Threat Intelligence
- IBM Cybersecurity Analyst Assessment
- IBM Cybersecurity Capstone: Breach Response Case Studies
- IBM Penetration Testing, Incident Response and Forensics
- IBM Network Security & Database Vulnerabilities
- IBM Introduction to Cybersecurity Tools & Cyberattacks
- IBM Operating Systems: Overview, Administration and Security

Technical Skills

- Security Tools: OWASP ZAP, Burp Suite, Wireshark
- Offensive Security: SQLi Testing, Manual Payload Fuzzing, DAST, Web Application Pentesting
- Defensive & Analysis: Cyber Threat Intelligence, Incident Response, Vulnerability Scanning, Log Analysis, Secrets Management
- Cloud & Infrastructure: Microsoft Azure (App Service, Azure Functions, Key Vault, Azure AD / Microsoft Identity Platform, Service Bus, Event Hub, Event Grid, Cosmos DB, Blob Storage, Container Registry, Container Instances, APIM, Redis Cache, Application Insights, Azure Monitor, ARM Templates)
- Languages: Python (automation & fuzzing), SQL, Java, C++, HTML
- Systems & Environments: Windows, XAMPP, WebGoat, Azure Portal

Soft Skills

- Analytical Problem Solving: Identified and resolved structural flaws in default scanning configurations, improving SQLi detection by 9%; applied the same investigative approach to Azure Monitor and Application Insights to identify and troubleshoot anomalous request patterns
- Technical Communication: Presented research to a non-technical audience at Keele Town Hall (Best Poster) and is co-publishing findings with academic faculty
- Self-Directed Learning: Completed 8+ industry-recognised certifications in threat intelligence, breach response, and cloud development alongside a 1st Class degree
- Project Management: Delivered a high-impact research dissertation from proposal through to co-publication, meeting all academic deadlines while managing multiple concurrent projects

Extracurricular Activities

- CyberFirst Advanced Programme (2019): Completed government-backed summer school covering penetration testing, encryption, and threat detection
- TryHackMe (2024–2025): Completed labs simulating SQLi, XSS, privilege escalation, and network-based attacks
- Hack Keele Society: Participated in ethical hacking meetups and Capture The Flag (CTF) events